BIOGRAPHY

# The Dance of Death

Gilles Corrozet and Jean de Vauzelles

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The Dance of Death

by Hans Holbein, with an

introductory note by

Austin Dobson

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# THE DANCE OF DEATH

=The Book=

"_Les Simulachres & Historiees Faces de la Mort avtant elegamtment pourtraictes, que artificiellement imaginees._" This may be Englished as follows: _The Images and Storied Aspects of Death, as elegantly delineated as [they are] ingeniously imagined._ Such is the literal title of the earliest edition of the famous book now familiarly known as "_Holbein's Dance of Death._" It is a small _quarto_, bearing on its title-page, below the French words above quoted, a nondescript emblem with the legend _Vsus me Genuit_, and on an open book, _Gnothe seauton_. Below this comes again, "_A Lyon, Soubz l'escu de Coloigne_: M. D. XXXVIII," while at the end of the volume is the imprint "_Excvdebant Lvgdvni Melchoir et Gaspar Trechsel fratres: 1538_,"--the Trechsels being printers of German origin, who had long been established at Lyons. There is a verbose "Epistre" or Preface in French to the "_moult reuerende Abbesse du religieux conuent S. Pierre de Lyon, Madame Iehanne de Touszele_," otherwise the Abbess of Saint Pierre les Nonnains, a religious house containing many noble and wealthy ladies, and the words, "_Salut d'un vray Zele_," which conclude the dedicatory heading, are supposed to reveal indirectly the author of the "Epistre" itself, namely, Jean de Vauzelles, Pastor of St. Romain and Prior of Monrottier, one of three famous literary brothers in the city on the Rhone, whose motto was "_D'un vray Zelle_." After the Preface comes "_Diuerses Tables de Mort, non painctes, mais extraictes de l'escripture saincte, colorees par Docteurs Ecclesiastiques, & umbragees par Philosophes_." Then follow the cuts, forty-one in number, each having its text from the Latin Bible above it, and below, its quatrain in French, this latter being understood to be from the pen of one Gilles Corozet. To the cuts succeed various makeweight Appendices of a didactic and hortatory character, the whole being wound up by a profitable discourse, _De la Necessite de la Mort qui ne laisse riens estre pardurable_. Various editions ensued to this first one of 1538, the next or second of 1542 (in which Corozet's verses were translated into Latin by Luther's brother-in-law, George Oemmel or Aemilius), being put forth by Jean and Francois Frellon, into whose hands the establishment of the Trechsels had fallen. There were subsequent issues in 1545, 1547, 1549, 1554, and 1562. To the issues of 1545 and

1562 a few supplementary designs were added, some of which have no special bearing upon the general theme, although attempts, more or less ingenious, have been made to connect them with the text. After 1562 no addition was made to the plates.

=The Artist=

From the date of the _editio princeps_ it might be supposed that the designs were executed at or about 1538--the year of its publication. But this is not the case; and there is good evidence that they were not only designed but actually cut on the wood some eleven years before the book itself was published. There are, in fact, several sets of impressions in the British Museum, the Berlin Museum, the Basle Museum, the Imperial Library at Paris, and the Grand Ducal Cabinet at Carlsruhe, all of which correspond with each other, and are believed to be engraver's proofs from the original blocks. These, which include every cut in the edition of 1538, except "The Astrologer," would prove little of themselves as to the date of execution. But, luckily, there exists in the Cabinet at Berlin a set of coarse enlarged drawings in Indian ink, on brownish paper, of twenty-three of the series. These are in circular form; and were apparently intended as sketches for glass painting. That they are copied from the woodcuts is demonstrable, first, because they are not reversed as they would have been if they were the originals; and, secondly, because one of them, No. 36 ("The Duchess"), repeats the conjoined "H.L." on the bed, which initials are held to be the monogram of the woodcutter, and not to be part of the original design. The Berlin drawings must therefore have been executed subsequently to the woodcuts; and as one of them, that representing the Emperor, is dated "1527," we get a date before which both the woodcuts, and the designs for the woodcuts, must have been prepared. It is generally held that they were so prepared _circa_ 1524 and 1525, the date of the Peasants' War, of the state of feeling excited by which they exhibit evident traces. In the Preface to this first edition, certain ambiguous expressions, to which we shall presently refer, led some of the earlier writers on the subject to doubt as to the designer of the series. But the later researches of Wornum and Woltmann, of M. Paul Mantz and, more recently, of Mr. W. J. Linton leave no doubt that they were really drawn by the artist to whom they have always been traditionally assigned, to wit, Hans Holbein the younger. He was resident in Basle up to the autumn of 1526, before which time, according to the above argument, the drawings must have been produced; he had already designed an Alphabet of Death; and, moreover, on the walls of the cemetery of the Dominican monastery at Basle there was a famous wall-painting of the Dance of Death, which would be a perpetual stimulus to any resident artist. Finally, and this is perhaps the most important consideration of all, the designs are in Holbein's manner.

=The Woodcutter=

But besides revealing an inventor of the highest order, the _Dance of Death_ also discloses an interpreter in wood of signal, and even superlative, ability. The designs are cut--to use the word which implies the employment of the knife as opposed to that of the graver--in a manner which has never yet been excelled. In this matter there could be no better judge than Mr. W. J. Linton; and he says that nothing, either by

knife or by graver, is of higher quality than these woodcuts. Yet the woodcutter's very name was for a long time doubtful, and even now the particulars which we possess with regard to him are scanty and inconclusive. That he was dead when the Trechsels published the book in 1538, must be inferred from the "Epistre" of Jean de Vauzelles, since that "Epistre" expressly refers to "_la mort de celluy, qui nous en a icy imagine si elegantes figures_"; and without entering into elaborate enquiry as to the exact meaning of "_imaginer_" in sixteenth-century French, it is obvious that, although the deceased is elsewhere loosely called "_painctre_," this title cannot refer to Holbein, who was so far from being dead that he survived until 1543. The only indication of the woodcutter's name is supplied by the monogram, "HL" upon the bedstead in No. 36 ("The Duchess"); and these initials have been supposed to indicate one Hans Lutzelburger, or Hans of Luxemburg, "otherwise Franck," a form-cutter ("formschneider"), whose full name is to be found attached to the so-called "Little Dance of Death," an alphabet by Holbein, impressions of which are in the British Museum. His signature ("H. L. F. 1522") is also found appended to another alphabet; to a cut of a fight in a forest, dated also 1522; and to an engraved title-page in a German New Testament of the year following. This is all we know with certainty concerning his work, though the investigations of Dr. Edouard His have established the fact that a "formschneider" named Hans, who had business transactions with the Trechsels of Lyons, had died at Basle before June, 1526; and it is conjectured, though absolute proof is not forthcoming, that this must have been the "H. L.," or Hans of Luxemburg, who cut Holbein's designs upon the wood. In any case, unless we must assume another woodcutter of equal merit, it is probable that the same man cut the signed Alphabet in the British Museum and the initialed _Dance of Death_. But why the cuts of the latter, which, as we have shown above, were printed _circa_ 1526, were not published at Lyons until 1538; and why Holbein's name was withheld in the Preface to the book of that year, are still unexplained. The generally accepted supposition is that motives of timidity, arising from the satirical and fearlessly unsparing character of the designs, may be answerable both for delay in the publication and mystification in the "Preface." And if intentional mystification be admitted, the doors of enquiry, after three hundred and fifty years, are practically sealed to the critical picklock.

=Other Reproductions=

The _Dance of Death_ has been frequently copied. Mr. W. J. Linton enumerates a Venice reproduction of 1545; and a set (enlarged) by Jobst Dienecker of Augsburg in 1554. Then there is the free copy, once popular with our great grandfathers, by Bewick's younger brother John, which Hodgson of Newcastle published in 1789 under the title of _Emblems of Mortality_. Wenceslaus Hollar etched thirty of the designs in 1651, and in 1788 forty-six of them were etched by David Deuchar. In 1832 they were reproduced upon stone with great care by Joseph Schlotthauer, Professor in the Academy of Fine Arts at Munich; and these were reissued in this country in 1849 by John Russell Smith. They have also been rendered in photo-lithography for an edition issued by H. Noel Humphreys, in 1868; and for the Holbein Society in 1879. In 1886, Dr. F. Lippmann edited for Mr. Quaritch a set of reproductions of the engraver's proofs in the Berlin Museum; and the _editio princeps_ has been facsimiled by one of

the modern processes for Hirth of Munich, as vol. x. of the Liebhaber-Bibliothek, 1884.

=The Present Issue=

The copies given in the present issue are impressions from the blocks engraved in 1833 for Douce's _Holbein's Dance of Death_. They are the best imitations in wood, says Mr. Linton. It is of course true, as he also points out, that a copy with the graver can never quite faithfully follow an original which has been cut with the knife,--more especially, it may be added, when the cutter is a supreme craftsman like him of Luxemburg. But against etched, lithographed, phototyped and otherwise-processed copies, these of Messrs. Bonner and John Byfield have one incontestable advantage: they are honest attempts to repeat by the same method,--that is, in wood,--the original and incomparable woodcuts of Hans Lutzelburger.

## THE DANCE OF DEATH

## (CHANT ROYAL, AFTER HOLBEIN)[1]

"_Contra vim Mortis_ _Non est medicamen in hortis._"

He is the despots' Despot. All must bide, Later or soon, the message of his might; Princes and potentates their heads must hide, Touched by the awful sigil of his right; Beside the Kaiser he at eve doth wait And pours a potion in his cup of state; The stately Queen his bidding must obey; No keen-eyed Cardinal shall him affray; And to the Dame that wantoneth he saith-- "Let be, Sweet-heart, to junket and to play." There is no king more terrible than Death.

The lusty Lord, rejoicing in his pride, He draweth down; before the armed Knight With jingling bridle-rein he still doth ride; He crosseth the strong Captain in the fight; The Burgher grave he beckons from debate; He hales the Abbot by his shaven pate, Nor for the Abbess' wailing will delay; No bawling Mendicant shall say him nay; E'en to the pyx the Priest he followeth, Nor can the Leech his chilling finger stay ... There is no king more terrible than Death.

All things must bow to him. And woe betide The Wine-bibber,--the Roisterer by night; Him the feast-master, many bouts defied, Him 'twixt the pledging and the cup shall smite; Woe to the Lender at usurious rate, The hard Rich Man, the hireling Advocate; Woe to the Judge that selleth right for pay; Woe to the Thief that like a beast of prey With creeping tread the traveller harryeth:-- These, in their sin, the sudden sword shall slay ... There is no king more terrible than Death.

He hath no pity,--nor will be denied. When the low hearth is garnished and bright, Grimly he flingeth the dim portal wide, And steals the Infant in the Mother's sight; He hath no pity for the scorned of fate:-- He spares not Lazarus lying at the gate, Nay, nor the Blind that stumbleth as he may; Nay, the tired Ploughman,--at the sinking ray,-- In the last furrow,--feels an icy breath, And knows a hand hath turned the team astray ... There is no king more terrible than Death.

He hath no pity. For the new-made Bride, Blithe with the promise of her life's delight, That wanders gladly by her Husband's side, He with the clatter of his drum doth fright; He scares the Virgin at the convent grate;

The Maid half-won, the lover passionate; He hath no grace for weakness and decay: The tender Wife, the Widow bent and gray, The feeble Sire whose footstep faltereth,-- All these he leadeth by the lonely way ... There is no king more terrible than Death.

ENVOY.

Youth, for whose ear and monishing of late, I sang of Prodigals and lost estate, Have thou thy joy of living and be gay; But know not less that there must come a day,-- Aye, and perchance e'en now it hasteneth,-- When thine own heart shall speak to thee and say,-- There is no king more terrible than Death.

1877. A. D.

[Footnote 1: This Chant Royal of the King of Terrors is--with Mr. AUSTIN DOBSON'S consent--here reprinted from his _Collected Poems_, 1896.]

## LIST OF ILLUSTRATIONS

N.B.--The German titles are in general modernized from those which appear above the engraver's proofs. The numerals are those of the cuts.

THE CREATION I _Die Schoepfung aller Ding._

Eve is taken from the side of Adam.

THE TEMPTATION II "_Adam Eua im Paradyss._"

Eve, having received an apple from the serpent, prompts Adam to gather more.

THE EXPULSION III "_Vsstribung Ade Eue._"

Adam and Eve, preceded by Death, playing on a beggar's lyre or hurdy-gurdy, are driven by the angel from Eden.

THE CONSEQUENCES OF THE FALL IV _Adam baut die Erden._

Adam, aided by Death, tills the earth. Eve, with a distaff, suckles Cain in the background.

A CEMETERY V _Gebein aller Menschen._

A crowd of skeletons, playing on horns, trumpets, and the like, summon mankind to the grave.

THE POPE VI _Der Paepst._

The Pope (Leo X.) with Death at his side, crowns an Emperor, who kisses his foot. Another Death, in a cardinal's hat, is among the assistants.

THE EMPEROR VII _Der Kaiser._

The Emperor (Maximilian I.) rates his minister for injustice to a suitor. But even in the act Death discrowns him.

THE KING VIII _Der Koenig._

The King (Francis I.) sits at feast under a baldachin sprinkled with _fleurs-de-lis_. Death, as a cup-bearer, pours his last draught.

THE CARDINAL IX _Der Cardinal._

Death lifts off the Cardinal's hat as he is handing a letter of indulgence to a rich man. Luther's opponent, Cardinal Cajetan, is supposed to be represented.

THE EMPRESS X _Die Kaiserinn._

The Empress, walking with her women, is intercepted by a female Death, who conducts her to an open grave.

THE QUEEN XI _Die Koeniginn._

Death, in the guise of a court-jester, drags away the Queen as she is leaving her palace.

THE BISHOP XII _Der Bischof._

The sun is setting, and Death leads the aged Bishop from the sorrowing shepherds of his flock.

THE DUKE XIII _Der Herzog._

The Duke turns pitilessly from a beggar-woman and her child. Meanwhile Death, fantastically crowned, lays hands on him.

THE ABBOT XIV _Der Abt._

Death, having despoiled the Abbot of mitre and crozier, hales him along unwilling, and threatening his enemy with his breviary.

THE ABBESS XV _Die Abtissin._

Death, in a wreath of flags, pulls away the Abbess by her scapulary in sight of a shrieking nun.

THE NOBLEMAN XVI _Der Edelmann._

Death drags the resisting Nobleman towards a bier in the background.

THE CANON, OR PREBENDARY XVII _Der Domherr._

The Canon, with his falconer, page, and jester, enters the church door. Death shows him that his sands have run.

THE JUDGE XVIII _Der Richter._

Death withdraws the Judge's staff as he takes a bribe from a rich suitor.

THE ADVOCATE XIX _Der Fuersprach._

Death comes upon him in the street while he is being feed by a rich client.

THE COUNSELLOR, OR SENATOR XX _Der Rathsherr._

The Counsellor, prompted by a devil, is absorbed by a nobleman, and turns unheeding from a poor suppliant. But Death, with glass and spade, is waiting at his feet.

THE PREACHER XXI _Der Predicant._

Death, in a stole, stands in the pulpit behind the fluent Preacher, and prepares to strike him down with a jaw-bone.

THE PRIEST, OR PASTOR XXII _Der Pfarrherr._

He carries the host to a sick person. But Death precedes him as his sacristan.

THE MENDICANT FRIAR XXIII _Der Moench._

Death seizes him just as his begging box and bag are filled.

THE NUN XXIV _Die Nonne._

The young Nun kneels at the altar, but turns to her lover who plays upon a lute. Death meantime, as a hideous old hag, extinguishes the altar candles.

THE OLD WOMAN XXV _Das Altweib._

"_Melior est mors quam vita_" to the aged woman who crawls gravewards with her bone rosary while Death makes music in the van.

THE PHYSICIAN XXVI _Der Arzt._

Death brings him a hopeless patient, and bids him cure himself.

THE ASTROLOGER XXVII (_See p. 10, l. 12._)

He contemplates a pendent sphere. But Death thrusts a skull before his eyes.

THE RICH MAN XXVIII _Der Reichmann._

Death finds him at his pay-table and seizes the money.

THE MERCHANT XXIX _Der Kaufmann._

Death arrests him among his newly-arrived bales.

THE SHIPMAN XXX _Der Schiffmann._

Death breaks the mast of the ship, and the crew are in extremity.

THE KNIGHT XXXI _Der Ritter._

Death, in cuirass and chain-mail, runs him through the body.

THE COUNT XXXII _Der Graf._

Death, as a peasant with a flail, lifts away his back-piece.

THE OLD MAN XXXIII _Der Altmann._

Death, playing on a dulcimer, leads him into his grave.

THE COUNTESS XXXIV _Die Grafinn._

Death helps her at her tiring by decorating her with a necklet of dead men's bones.

THE NOBLE LADY, OR BRIDE XXXV _Die Edelfrau._

"_Me et te sola mors separabit_"--says the motto. And Death already dances before her.

THE DUCHESS XXXVI _Die Herzoginn._

Death seizes her in bed, while his fellow plays the fiddle.

THE PEDLAR XXXVII _Der Kramer._

Death stops him on the road with his wares at his back.

THE PLOUGHMAN XXXVIII _Der Ackermann._

Death runs at the horses' sides as the sun sinks, and the furrows are completed.

THE YOUNG CHILD XXXIX _Das Junge Kind._

As the meagre cottage meal is preparing, Death steals the youngest child.

THE LAST JUDGMENT XL _Das juengste Gericht._

"_Omnes stabimus ante tribunal Domini._"

THE ESCUTCHEON OF DEATH XLI _Die Wappen des Todes._

The supporters represent Holbein and his wife.

[_Added in later editions_]

## THE SOLDIER XLII

Death, armed only with a bone and shield, fights with the Soldier on the field of battle.

## THE GAMESTER XLIII

Death and the Devil seize upon the Gambler at his cards.

## THE DRUNKARD XLIV

Men and women carouse: down the throat of one bloated fellow Death pours the wine.

## THE FOOL XLV

The Fool dances along the highway with Death, who plays the bagpipes.

## THE ROBBER XLVI

Death seizes the Robber in the act of pillage.

## THE BLIND MAN XLVII

Death leads the Blind Man by his staff.

## THE WAGGONER XLVIII

The waggon is overturned; one Death carries off a wheel, the other loosens the fastening of a cask.

## THE BEGGAR XLIX

The Beggar, lying on straw outside the city, cries in vain for Death.

[Two others, not found in the earlier editions, "The Young Wife," and "The Young Husband," are not included in the Douce reprint for which the foregoing blocks were engraved.]

Les simulachres &

## HISTORIEES FACES

## DE LA MORT, AVTANT ELE

gammet pourtraictes, que artificiellement imaginees.

[Illustration: Vsus me genuit.]

## A LYON,

Soubz l'escu de COLOIGNE,

M. D. XXXVIII.

## I.

[Illustration: THE CREATION.]

Formauit DOMINVS DEVS hominem de limo terrae, ad imagine suam creauit illum, masculum & foeminam creauit eos.

Genesis i. & ii.

DIEV, Ciel, Mer, Terre, procrea De rien demonstrant sa puissance Et puis de la terre crea L'homme, & la femme a sa semblance.

## II.

[Illustration: THE TEMPTATION.]

Quia audisti vocem vxoris tuae, & comedisti de ligno ex quo preceperam tibi ne comederes, &c.

Genesis iii.

ADAM fut par EVE deceu Et contre DIEV mangea la pomme, Dont tous deux ont la Mort receu, Et depuis fut mortel tout homme.

## III.

[Illustration: THE EXPULSION.]

Emisit eum DOMINVS DEVS de Paradiso voluptatis, vt operaretur terram de qua sumptus est.

Genesis iii.

DIEV chassa l'homme de plaisir Pour uiure au labeur de ses mains: Alors la Mort le uint saisir, Et consequemment tous humains.

## IV.

[Illustration: THE CONSEQUENCES OF THE FALL.]

Maledicta terra in opere tuo, in laboribus comedes cunctis diebus vitae tuae, donec reuertaris, &c.

Genesis iii.

Mauldicte en ton labeur la terre. En labeur ta uie useras, Iusques que la Mort te soubterre. Toy pouldre en pouldre tourneras.

## V.

[Illustration: A CEMETERY.]

Vae vae vae habitantibus in terra.

Apocalypsis viii.

Cuncta in quibus spiraculum vitae est, mortua sunt.

Genesis vii.

Malheureux qui uiuez au monde Tousiours remplis d'aduersitez, Pour quelque bien qui uous abonde, Serez tous de Mort uisitez.

## VI.

[Illustration: THE POPE.]

Moriatur sacerdos magnus.

Iosve xx.

Et episcopatum eius accipiat alter.

Psalmista cviii.

Qui te cuydes immortel estre Par Mort seras tost depesche, Et combien que tu soys grand prebstre, Vng aultre aura ton Euesche.

## VII.

[Illustration: THE EMPEROR.]

Dispone domui tuae, morieris enim tu, & non viues.

Isaiae xxxviii.

Ibi morieris, & ibi erit currus gloriae tuae.

Isaiae xxii.

De ta maison disposeras Comme de ton bien transitoire, Car la ou mort reposeras, Seront les chariotz de ta gloire.

## VIII.

[Illustration: THE KING.]

Sicut & rex hodie est, & cras morietur, nemo enim ex regibus aliud habuit.

Ecclesiastici x.

Ainsi qu'auiourdhuy il est Roy, Demain sera en tombe close. Car Roy aulcun de son arroy N'a sceu emporter aultre chose.

## IX.

[Illustration: THE CARDINAL.]

Vae qui iustificatis impium pro muneribus, & iustitiam iusti aufertis ab eo.

Esaiae v.

Mal pour uous qui iustifiez L'inhumain, & plain de malice Et par dons le sanctifiez, Ostant au iuste sa iustice.

## X.

[Illustration: THE EMPRESS.]

Gradientes in superbia potest Deus humiliare.

Danie iiii.

Qui marchez en pompe superbe La Mort vng iour uous pliera. Come soubz uoz piedz ployez l'herbe Ainsi uous humiliera.

## XI.

[Illustration: THE QUEEN.]

Mulieres opulentae surgite, & audite vocem meam. Post dies, & annum, & vos conturbemini.

Isaiae xxxii.

Leuez uous dames opulentes. Ouyez la uoix des trespassez. Apres maintz ans & iours passez, Serez troublees & doulentes.

## XII.

[Illustration: THE BISHOP.]

Percutiam pastorem, & dispergentur oues.

xxvi. Mar. xiiii.

Le pasteur aussi frapperay, Mitres & crosses renuersees. Et lors quand ie l'attrapperay, Seront ses brebis dispersees.

## XIII.

[Illustration: THE DUKE.]

Princeps induetur moerore. Et quiescere faciam superbia potentium.

Ezechie. vii.

Vien, prince, auec moy, & delaisse Honneurs mondains tost finissantz. Seule suis qui, certes, abaisse L'orgueil & pompe des puissantz.

## XIV.

[Illustration: THE ABBOT.]

Ipse morietur. Quia no habuit disciplinam, & in multitudine stultitiae suae decipietur.

Prover. v.

Il mourra. Car il n'a receu En soy aulcune discipline, Et au nombre sera deceu De folie qui le domine.

## XV.

[Illustration: THE ABBESS.]

Laudaui magis mortuos quam viuentes.

Eccle. iiii.

I'ay tousiours les mortz plus loue Que les uisz, esquelz mal abonde, Toucesfoys la Mort ma noue Au ranc de ceulx qui sont au monde.

## XVI.

[Illustration: THE NOBLEMAN.]

Quis est homo qui viuet, & non videbit mortem, eruet anima suam de manu inferi?

Psal. lxxxviii.

Qui est celluy, tant soit grande homme, Qui puisse uiure sans mourir? Et de la Mort, qui tout assomme, Puisse son Ame recourir?

## XVII.

[Illustration: THE CANON.]

Ecce appropinquat hora.

Mat. xxvi.

Tu uas au choeur dire tes heures Paiant Dieu pour toy, & ton proche. Mais il fault ores que tu meures. Voy tu pas l'heure qui approche?

## XVIII.

[Illustration: THE JUDGE.]

Disperdam iudicem de medio eius.

Amos ii.

Du mylieu d'eulx uous osteray Iuges corrumpus par presentz. Point ne serez de Mort exemptz. Car ailleurs uous transporteray.

## XIX.

[Illustration: THE ADVOCATE.]

Callidus vidit malum, & abscodit se innocens, pertransijt, & afflictus est damno.

Prover. xxii.

L'homme cault a ueu la malice Pour l'innocent faire obliger, Et puis par uoye de iustice Est uenu le pauure affliger.

## XX.

[Illustration: THE COUNSELLOR.]

Qui obturat aurem suam ad clamorem pauperis, & ipse clamabit, & non exaudietur.

Prover. xxi.

Les riches conseillez tousiours, Et aux pauures clouez l'oreille. Vous crierez aux derniers iours, Mais Dieu uous fera la pareille.

## XXI.

[Illustration: THE PREACHER.]

Vae qui dicitis malum bonum, & bonum malu, ponentes tenebras lucem, & lucem tenebras, ponentes amarum dulce, & dulce in amarum.

Isaiae xv.

Mal pour uous qui ainsi osez Le mal pour le bien nous blasmer, Et le bien pour mal exposez, Mettant auec le doulx l'amer.

## XXII.

[Illustration: THE PRIEST.]

Sum quidem & ego mortalis homo.

Sap. vii.

Ie porte le sainct sacrement Cuidant le mourant secourir, Qui mortel suis pareillement. Et comme luy me fault mourir.

## XXIII.

[Illustration: THE MENDICANT FRIAR.]

Sedentes in tenebris, & in vmbra mortis, vinctos in mendicitate.

Psal. cvi.

Toy qui n'as soucy, ny remord Sinon de ta mendicite, Tu fierras a l'umbre de Mort Pour t'ouster de necessite.

## XXIV.

[Illustration: THE NUN.]

Est via quae videtur homini iusta: nouissima autem eius deducunt hominem ad mortem.

Prover. iiii.

Telle uoye aux humains est bonne, Et a l'homme tresiuste semble. Mais la fin d'elle a l'homme donne, La Mort, qui tous pecheurs assemble.

## XXV.

[Illustration: THE OLD WOMAN.]

Melior est mors quam vita.

Eccle. xxx.

En peine ay uescu longuement Tant que nay plus de uiure enuie, Mais bien ie croy certainement, Meilleure la Mort que la uie.

## XXVI.

[Illustration: THE PHYSICIAN.]

Medice, cura teipsum.

Lvcae iiii.

Tu congnoys bien la maladie Pour le patient secourir, Et si ne scais teste estourdie, Le mal dont tu deburas mourir.

## XXVII.

[Illustration: THE ASTROLOGER.]

Indica mihi si nosti omnia. Sciebas quod nasciturus esses, & numerum dierum tuorum noueras?

Iob xxviii.

Tu dis par Amphibologie Ce qu'aux aultres doibt aduenir. Dy moy donc par Astrologie Quand tu deburas a moy uenir?

## XXVIII.

[Illustration: THE RICH MAN.]

Stulte hac nocte repetunt animam tuam, & quae parasti cuius erunt?

Lvcae xii.

Ceste nuict la Mort te prendra, Et demain seras enchasse. Mais dy moy, fol, a qui uiendra Le bien que tu as amasse?

## XXIX.

[Illustration: THE MERCHANT.]

Qui congregat thesauros mendacij vanus & excors est, & impingetur ad laqueos mortis.

Prover. xxi.

Vain est cil qui amassera Grandz biens, & tresors pour mentir, La Mort l'en fera repentir. Car en ses lacz surpris sera.

## XXX.

[Illustration: THE SHIPMAN.]

Qui volunt diuites fieri incidunt in laqueum diaboli, & desideria multa, & nociua, quae mergunt homines in interitum.

I. Ad Timo. vi.

Pour acquerir des biens mondains Vous entrez en tentation, Qui uous met es perilz soubdains, Et uous maine a perdition.

## XXXI.

[Illustration: THE KNIGHT.]

Subito morientur, & in media nocte turbabuntur populi, & auferent violentum absque manu.

Iob xxxiiii.

Peuples soubdain s'esleuront A lencontre de l'inhumain, Et le uiolent osteront D'auec eulx sans force de main.

## XXXII.

[Illustration: THE COUNT.]

Quoniam cum interiet non sumet secum omnia, neque cum eo descendet gloria eius.

Psal. xlviii.

Auec soy rien n'emportera, Mais qu'une foys la Mort le tombe, Rien de sa gloire n'ostera, Pour mettre auec soy en sa tombe.

## XXXIII.

[Illustration: THE OLD MAN.]

Spiritus meus attenuabitur, dies mei breuiabuntur, & solum mihi superest sepulchrum.

Iob xvii.

Mes esperitz sont attendriz, Et ma uie s'en ua tout beau. Las mes longziours sont amoindriz, Plus ne me reste qu'un tombeau.

## XXXIV.

[Illustration: THE COUNTESS.]

Ducunt in bonis dies suos, & in puncto ad inferna descendunt.

Iob xxi.

En biens modains leurs iours despendet En uoluptez, & en tristesse, Puis soubdain aux Enfers descendent Ou leur ioye passe en tristesse.

## XXXV.

[Illustration: THE NOBLE LADY.]

Me & te sola mors separabit.

Rvth. i.

Amour qui unyz nous faict uiure, En foy noz cueurs preparera, Qui long temps ne nous pourra suyure, Car la Mort nous separera.

## XXXVI.

[Illustration: THE DUCHESS.]

De lectulo super quem ascendisti non descendes, sed morte morieris.

iiii. Reg. i.

Du lict sus lequel as monte Ne descendras a ton plaisir. Car Mort t'aura tantost dompte, Et en brief te uiendra saisir.

## XXXVII.

[Illustration: THE PEDLAR.]

Venite ad me qui onerati estis.

Matth. xi.

Venez, & apres moy marchez Vous qui estes par trop charge. Cest assez suiuy les marchez: Vous serez par moy decharge.

## XXXVIII.

[Illustration: THE PLOUGHMAN.]

In sudore vultus tui vesceris pane tuo.

Gene. i.

A la sueur de ton uisaige Tu gaigneras ta pauure uie. Apres long trauail, & usaige, Voicy la Mort qui te conuie.

## XXXIX.

[Illustration: THE YOUNG CHILD.]

Homo natus de muliere, breui viuens tempore repletur multis miserijs, qui quasi flos egreditur, & conteritur, & fugit velut vmbra.

Iob xiiii.

Tout homme de la femme yssant Remply de misere, & d'encombre, Ainsi que fleur tost finissant. Sort & puis fuyt comme faict l'umbre.

## XL.

[Illustration: THE LAST JUDGMENT.]

Omnes stabimus ante tribunal domini.

Roma. xiiii.

Vigilate, & orate, quia nescitis qua hora venturus sit dominus.

Matt. xxiiii.

Deuante le trosne du grand iuge Chascun de soy compte rendra Pourtant ueillez, qu'il ne uous iuge. Car ne scauez quand il uiendra.

## XLI.

[Illustration: THE ESCUTCHEON OF DEATH.]

Memorare nouissima, & in aeternum non peccabis.

Eccle. vii.

Si tu ueulx uiure sans peche Voy ceste imaige a tous propos, Et point ne seras empesche, Quand tu t'en iras a repos.

## [ADDED IN LATER EDITIONS]

## XLII.

[Illustration: THE SOLDIER.]

Cum fortis armatus custodit atrium suum, &c. Si autem fortior eo superueniens vicerit eum, uniuersa eius arma aufert, in quibus confidebat.

Le sort arme en jeune corps Pense auoir seure garnison; Mais Mort plus forte, le met hors De sa corporelle maison.

## XLIII.

[Illustration: THE GAMESTER.]

Quid prodest homini, si vniuersum Mundum lucretur, animae autem suae detrimentum patiatur?

Matt. xvi.

Que vault a l'homme tout le Monde Gaigner d'hazard, & chance experte, S'il recoit de sa uie immonde Par Mort, irreparable perte?

## XLIV.

[Illustration: THE DRUNKARD.]

Ne inebriemini vino, in quo est luxuria.

Ephes. v.

De vin (auquel est tout exces) Ne vous enyurez pour dormir Sommeil de Mort qui au deces Vous face l'ame, & sang vomir.

## XLV.

[Illustration: THE FOOL.]

Quasi agnus lasciuiens, & ignorans, nescit quod ad vincula stultus trahatur.

Proverb vii.

Le Fol vit en ioye, & deduict San scavoir qu'il s'en va mourant, Tant qu'a sa fin il est conduict Ainsi que l'agneau ignorant.

## XLVI.

[Illustration: THE ROBBER.]

Domine, vim patior.

Isaiae xxxviii.

La foible femme brigandee Crie, O seigneur on me fait force. Lors de Dieu la mort est mandee, Qui les estrangle a dure estorce.

## XLVII.

[Illustration: THE BLIND MAN.]

Caecus caecum ducit: & ambo in foueam cadunt.

Matth. xv.

L'aueugle un autre aueugle guide, L'un par l'autre en la fosse tombe: Car quand plus oultre aller il cuide, La MORT l'homme iecte en la tombe.

## XLVIII.

[Illustration: THE WAGGONER.]

Corruit in curru suo.

i Chron. xxii.

Au passage de MORT peruerse Raison, chartier tout esperdu, Du corps le char, & cheuaux verse, Le vin (sang de vie) espandu.

## XLIX.

[Illustration: THE BEGGAR.]

Miser ego homo! Quis nie liberabit de corpore mortis huius?

Rom. vii.

Qui hors la chair veult en Christ viure Ne craint mort, mais dit un mortel, Helas, qui me rendra deliure Pouure homme de ce corps mortel?

* * * * *

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[Transcriber's Note: In the work used for this digitization, each pair of facing pages has the Latin biblical quotation at the top of the left page printed in red, the French quatrain at the bottom of the left page printed in black, and the illustration (numbered above, and captioned below) on the right page, opposite the text. For clarity in the text-only version, the plate numbers and captions have been moved to precede their corresponding verses.]